The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Eight Goddesses

Āryāṣṭadevīdhāraṇī · Toh 999 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ལྷ་མོ་བརྒྱད་kyi་གཟུངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Eight Goddesses, known in Sanskrit as the Āryāṣṭadevīdhāraṇī and in Tibetan as 'Phags pa lha mo brgyad kyi gzungs, is a brief incantatory scripture in which the bodhisattva Vajrapāṇi proclaims a powerful dhāraṇī-mantra. The text praises this mantra as a supreme great queen among dhāraṇīs and as the mother of the tathāgatas, a feminine power said to purify all wrongdoing, pacify every illness, destroy all obstructing forces, and bring about every kind of excellence. After a short homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, the work consists mainly of the mantra itself, followed by a statement naming it as the dhāraṇī of a particular blessed goddess. It is Toh 999 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the large class of dhāraṇī texts, the short works of protective and purifying recitation that are gathered together in the canon's collection of dhāraṇīs.

In the language of India: ārya aṣṭadevī dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Eight Goddesses.

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Then Vajrapāṇi spoke this supreme great queen of dhāraṇī-mantras, the mother of the tathāgatas, she who purifies all sins, completely pacifies all illnesses, utterly destroys all obstructors, and brings about every excellence:

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā he buddha mātari sarva pāvanāśani garja garja bhañja bhañja marda marda gambhari gambhari hasa hasa dama dama matha matha vidhransaya vidhānaya sarva śatūn taramati vimale vūraya pūraya pratijñāna sarva buddha paryupasiti bhagavati gana gana jahi jahi vimasani kramaṇi dhavani ramaṇi mātaṃgige svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called She Who Is Endowed with Empowerment into Great Wisdom.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā amari amari taṭa bhañja bhañja jha jha mici mici sphoṭaya sphoṭaya matha matha durdānta damaka svāhā

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā he he kinade sarva tathāgata bhaneke bhodhi nadad tvāṭa tvāṭa hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ phaṭ garja garja varamati vihurike svāhā

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā bhagavati prajñāpāramite a sarva pāpa kṣayaṃkari jñena arcisparaṇi bhañja bhañja matha matha dama dama ānaya ānaya sara sara māraya māraya sarva buddha janetrīyai svāhā

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā garja garja matha matha dhama dhama bhañja bhañja dundubhi sarva nirghoṣe hana hana bhidhvansaya vidhvansaya moṭaya moṭaya daha daha viphula nirmal nirjāte āhara āhara gaccha gaccha sarva buddha paryupasatima māvilamā svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called Vajradhātvīśvarī.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā oṃ bhagavati sarva tathāgata janika vūraya pratijñāna taṭa taṭa marda marda āhara āhara hūṃ hūṃ jati svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called Mahāpratisarā.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā hūṃ hrīḥ sarva buddha mātiri bhañja bhañja matha matha damani damani gargāri gargāri hrī svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called Invincible Vajra Lady.

namaḥ sarva tathātebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā trāṭa trāṭa muhu muhu sarva pāpa viśodhani svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called She Who Removes All Sins.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā dhaka dhaka moṭa moṭa daha daha sarva tathāgata jñāna nirjāta svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called She Who Is Hard to Tame.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā haha mihu mihu dama dama khāhi khāhi dhuna dhuna mici mici durdānta damani svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called She Who Utterly Vanquishes All Māras.

namaḥ sarva tathāgatebhyaḥ sarva mukhebhyaḥ sarvathā mici mici garja garja sphoṭaya sphoṭaya matha matha dama dama svāhā

This is the dhāraṇī of the Blessed Lady called She Who Accomplishes the Infinite Doors.

Mañjuśrī, whoever holds this maṇḍala of empowerment into great wisdom in his hand will become free of afflictions and free of fear. He may stay among bandits, among rākṣasas, or among enemies, or even be in the midst of battle. Even so, weapons will not harm his body, he will not be robbed by bandits, and he will not be harmed by rākṣasas and the like. For him no fear of untimely death will arise, and he will always be endowed with glory. All his sins will be completely purified. Even the roots of virtue accumulated with hundreds of thousands of millions of billions of buddhas will become manifest to him as if in a single day. At the time of death, too, he will be embraced by the buddhas and bodhisattvas, and after death he will go to Sukhāvatī. If that is so, what need is there to speak of one who holds it, reads it, keeps it in mind, and holds it without letting it go? All his obscurations will be purified. He will close the doors to the lower realms. He will be far removed from the lower realms and the bad destinies.

Whoever rises in the morning
And recites it a single time
Will be freed from all the sins
Committed in perilous existence.
Rākṣasas and the like, and bandits,
Weapons and enemies cannot harm him;
He is fully freed from untimely death
And will always be endowed with glory.
At the time of death as well,
He will be kept far from the lower destinies;
Embraced by the buddhas,
He will be born in Sukhāvatī.

When this had been spoken, the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised it highly.

The Noble Dhāraṇī of the Eight Goddesses is complete.

It was translated, edited, and finalized by the Indian preceptor Śīlendrabodhi and the chief editor and translator, the monk Yeshé Dé.

Translator's Notes

• The words "Mañjuśrī, whoever holds this maṇḍala of empowerment into great wisdom" may instead be read without an address, as "whoever holds this maṇḍala of Mañjuśrī's empowerment into great wisdom."

The text names only some of the dhāraṇīs, and its names do not neatly yield eight goddesses. They are given as they stand.

Except for Vajradhātvīśvarī and Mahāpratisarā, the goddesses' names are translated by meaning, because their Sanskrit forms cannot be identified with confidence. Vajradhātvīśvarī means "Sovereign Lady of the Vajra Realm." "Invincible Vajra Lady" may correspond to a Vajrāparājitā.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.